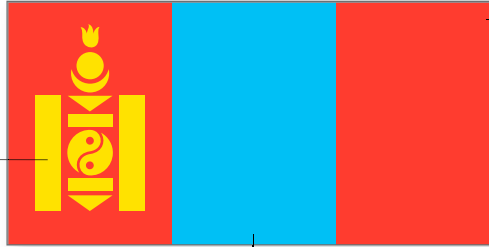


Mongolia

Ratio: 2:1 **Adopted:** 1992 **Usage:** Civil and State

The *soyonbo* device combines a number of Buddhist emblems



Originally the color of communism, today red represents progress

Sky blue is the national color of Mongolia

Asia



Mongolia is a remote state that has been under communist rule since 1924. The former Communist Party was democratically re-elected in 1997.

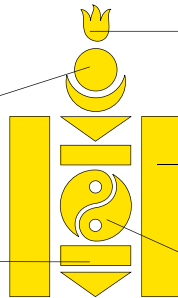
The current national flag replaced the Red flag of revolution in 1940. The red field is retained at the fly and hoist, although the color's original socialist connotations have given way to more general themes of progress and prosperity. The sky-blue panel represents the people of Mongolia and invokes the imperial

days of Genghis Khan. The flag bears a 17th-century Buddhist emblem at hoist called the *soyonbo*. The *soyonbo* comprises various ideograms representing different elements from the Buddhist view of the world. The communist star which appeared above the *soyonbo* was removed in 1992.

THE SOYONBO

The sun and moon represent ancestors of the Moguls

Horizontal bars indicate that vigilance is required from the highest and lowest in society



The tongues of the flame stand for past, present, and future

The vertical columns illustrate the Mongolian proverb "Two friends are stronger than stone"

The fish stand for vigilance because fish never sleep